

Straep — User Types and Personas

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Document owner: Product / UX Team

Dependency: Informs onboarding flows, feature gating, navigation structure, and copy tone.

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1. Overview

Straep serves five distinct user types. Each has a different primary motivation for joining the platform, different actions they take daily, and a different relationship to the subscription model. Understanding these differences is essential for designing the right onboarding flow, dashboard layout, navigation, and copy for each type.

The most important principle: **Straep must be equally engaging for personal users and for business users.** If only businesses are on the platform, there is no audience for them to reach. If only personal users join, there is no content worth returning for.

2. Personal User

2.1 Description

Personal users are consumers: people who join Straep not to sell anything, but to discover brands, consume content, find deals, apply for opportunities, and interact with businesses and creators they like.

This group is the lifeblood of the platform. Without them, businesses have no audience. Every engagement decision — the feed algorithm, discovery design, community features, and opportunity board — should prioritise keeping personal users active, returning, and finding value even on days they don't make a purchase inquiry.

2.2 Representative Persona

Name: Chisom, 26

Occupation: Marketing executive, Lagos

Device: iPhone, primarily mobile

Behaviour pattern: Checks social feeds in the morning and during lunch. Follows fashion brands on Instagram. Finds services by asking on WhatsApp groups. Has been "burned" by unverified businesses before — she now reads reviews before buying anything online.

What she wants from Straep:

- Discover vetted, reviewed local brands she can trust.
- Save products she wants to buy later.
- Follow brands and get their updates without switching to a different app.
- Read reviews from real customers before sending an inquiry.
- Apply for job or internship opportunities posted by brands.

Frustrations:

- Discovering a business on Instagram only to find it has no reviews, no clear pricing, and the DMs never get answered.
- Receiving spam in WhatsApp groups when asking for service recommendations.

2.3 Primary Actions

- Sign up and set up a personal profile.
- Select interests during onboarding (drives feed and discovery recommendations).
- Follow brands and creators from the Home Feed and Discover page.
- Browse the Home Feed (brand posts, offers, educational content, opportunities).
- Use the Discover page to find businesses by category, location, and rating.
- View brand pages and read reviews, testimonials, and product listings.
- Save products or services to a personal wishlist.
- Send inquiries to brands from their page.
- Join communities.
- Apply for opportunities (jobs, internships, collaborations) posted by brands.
- Like, comment, share, and save posts.
- Review a brand after a successful interaction.

2.4 Navigation Experience

Personal users see the standard app navigation:

- Bottom bar (mobile): Home, Discover, Create (+), Market, Profile.
- They do not see the Business Dashboard or Developer Dashboard.

2.5 Subscription Relationship

Personal accounts are always free. There is no paid personal plan in the MVP. In Phase 3 or later, personal users who start building a portfolio or adding services can be prompted to upgrade to a Creator account.

2.6 Retention Hooks

The product must give personal users a reason to return daily. The key retention mechanics are:

- **Daily feed:** New posts from followed brands every day.
 - **Deals and offers:** Time-limited offers from brands they follow.
 - **Opportunity board:** New jobs, internships, and collaborations posted regularly.
 - **Community activity:** Discussions, polls, and challenges in joined communities.
 - **Saved items:** Building a wishlist creates a bookmark-like habit.
 - **Brand challenges:** Brands run periodic challenges with rewards.
 - **Personalised recommendations:** Feed improves as the user interacts more.
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3. Business / Brand User

3.1 Description

Business users are Straep's primary paying customers. They join to establish a professional brand presence, attract customers, receive inquiries, and manage business growth — all from one platform. They are the group most likely to upgrade from Free to Professional, and they are the primary revenue driver.

3.2 Representative Persona

Name: Tunde, 34

Business: A Lagos-based graphic design studio (4 employees)

Device: Android phone + MacBook

Behaviour pattern: Currently manages his brand across Instagram (posts), WhatsApp Business (inquiries), and a simple website (rarely updated). He gets inquiries via DMs that he sometimes misses. He cannot tell which platforms are actually driving business.

What he wants from Straep:

- A branded page that looks professional without hiring a developer.
- A clear way for potential clients to send him inquiries.
- A dashboard where he can see all incoming leads in one place.
- Some analytics showing which services are getting the most views.
- Eventually, the ability to show reviews and testimonials on his page.

Frustrations:

- Instagram makes his design page look identical to a personal account.
- He has no idea which posts actually lead to client inquiries.
- His website costs him money but gets almost no traffic.
- DMs from potential clients get buried under other messages.

3.3 Primary Actions

During onboarding:

- Select "Business/Brand Account."
- Enter business name, category, industry, location, contact details.
- Upload logo and cover image.
- Select a starter template.
- Customise basic sections.
- Publish page.

Day-to-day:

- Log in → land on Business Dashboard.
- Check new leads in the Leads inbox.
- Reply to or update the status of leads.
- Create posts (product updates, offers, educational content).
- Add or edit products and services.
- Monitor dashboard metrics (views, followers, inquiry count).

Growth actions:

- Hit a Free plan limit → upgrade to Professional.
- Buy a premium template from the marketplace.
- Apply for the verified badge (Phase 3).
- Run a promoted post campaign (Phase 3).

3.4 Navigation Experience

Business users land on `/dashboard` after login, not on the Feed. Their mobile bottom bar is: Dashboard, Feed, Create (+), Discover, Profile.

The full Business Dashboard sidebar gives them access to: Overview, Brand Page, Storefront, Posts, Leads, Analytics, Templates, Subscription, Settings.

3.5 Subscription Relationship

Business users have the clearest upgrade path:

1. Sign up free → publish basic page.
2. Receive their first inquiry → start managing leads.
3. Hit a customisation limit → see upgrade prompt.
4. Upgrade to Professional to unlock full customisation and analytics.
5. As business grows → upgrade to Business plan for team members and advanced features.

The upgrade trigger should feel natural, not pushy. The Free plan should give enough value to prove the platform works, but clearly limit enough features that the value of upgrading is obvious.

3.6 Business Categories at Launch

Straep should have built-in category support for these business types from Day 1:

- Fashion and clothing

- Food and restaurant
 - Beauty and wellness
 - Education and tutoring
 - Technology and software
 - Creative services (design, photography, video)
 - Consulting and coaching
 - Real estate
 - Health and fitness
 - Retail and e-commerce
 - Events and entertainment
 - Church and ministry
 - NGO and non-profit
 - Legal and financial services
 - Travel and hospitality
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4. Creator / Professional User

4.1 Description

Creators and professionals are individual personal brands — not registered companies, but people whose professional identity is their product. They include coaches, consultants, designers, developers, writers, tutors, public speakers, musicians, and content creators.

They need a space that is more professional than Instagram, more expressive than LinkedIn, and more business-functional than a portfolio website.

4.2 Representative Persona

Name: Adaeze, 29

Occupation: Brand strategist and business coach

Device: iPhone + MacBook

Behaviour pattern: Posts regularly on LinkedIn and Instagram. Has a simple Notion page as her portfolio. Gets coaching clients mostly through referrals and Instagram DMs. Has no way to collect testimonials from past clients in one visible place.

What she wants from Straep:

- A beautiful personal brand page that shows her services, portfolio, and client testimonials.
- A way for potential clients to book a discovery call or send an inquiry directly from her page.
- A place to publish her content (articles, tips, offers) that also reaches an audience.
- Social proof: reviews and testimonials visible on her profile.

Frustrations:

- LinkedIn feels too corporate and her posts don't reach potential clients.
- Instagram feels too informal for business conversations.

- She has to manually send potential clients her portfolio link separately from her social profile.

4.3 Primary Actions

- Build a creator/professional brand page (same builder as business users, with creator-specific sections: About Me, Services, Portfolio, Testimonials, Booking CTA).
- Showcase portfolio pieces with descriptions.
- List services with starting price, duration, and inquiry/booking CTA.
- Publish educational content, tips, behind-the-scenes posts.
- Collect and display testimonials from past clients (Phase 3).
- Receive and manage booking inquiries via the Lead dashboard.
- Build an audience of followers who consume their content.

4.4 Differences from Business User

- A Creator account is personal (one individual), not a company.
- Profile shows individual name + professional title (e.g., "Adaeze — Brand Strategist") rather than a business name.
- Portfolio is more prominent than the storefront.
- "Book a Session" or "Hire Me" CTA replaces "Visit Storefront."
- Content focus: educational and personal brand storytelling, not product promotions.

4.5 Onboarding Differences

Creator onboarding asks:

- Professional title/category.
- What services do you offer?
- Do you have a portfolio to showcase?
- What kind of content will you share?

Starter sections suggested for creators: About Me, Services, Portfolio, Testimonials, Contact.

5. Developer / Designer User

5.1 Description

Developer users are the supply side of the template marketplace. They build and sell page templates — not brand pages — and their primary motivation is revenue. They join Straep as a commercial partner, not a social user.

Developer accounts are Phase 4. However, the design of brand pages, page sections, and the template format must be planned with developers in mind from Phase 1, to ensure templates are feasible when the marketplace launches.

5.2 Representative Persona

Name: Emmanuel, 27

Occupation: Freelance frontend developer

Device: MacBook + desktop monitor

Behaviour pattern: Builds websites for clients. Has previously sold themes on ThemeForest. Wants a more modern marketplace with a better revenue share and a built-in audience of business users actively looking to improve their brand pages.

What he wants from Straep:

- A marketplace where his templates are seen by active paying users.
- A fair revenue split (70/30 is acceptable).
- A simple upload and submission process.
- A dashboard to track sales, reviews, and payout status.
- Clear documentation on how to build compatible templates.

5.3 Primary Actions (Phase 4)

- Register as a Developer account.
- Complete developer profile (display name, bio, payout bank details).
- Upload a template using the developer upload form.
- Wait for admin review and approval.
- Monitor template performance: sales, downloads, reviews.
- Request a payout when the balance threshold is met.
- Update or revise templates based on reviews.

5.4 Template Format Requirements (for engineers and designers to plan)

Templates must define:

- Supported page sections (e.g., this template supports: Hero, Products, Testimonials, Contact — but not Portfolio).
- Colour scheme tokens (overrideable by the brand owner's brand colours).
- Font pairing (overrideable by Professional plan users).
- Preview images (minimum 3: desktop full-page, mobile full-page, section close-up).
- Category (Fashion, Restaurant, School, etc.).
- A metadata JSON file that Straep reads to apply the template to the brand page editor.

5.5 Revenue and Payout Rules

- Developer earns 70% of each sale.
 - Straep earns 30% commission.
 - Minimum payout threshold: ₦10,000.
 - Payout frequency: Twice monthly (1st and 15th of each month).
 - Payout via bank transfer (Nigeria) or via Paystack split payment.
 - Developer is responsible for their own tax obligations on earnings.
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6. Agency User

6.1 Description

Agency users are branding agencies, marketing teams, or digital consultants who manage multiple client brand pages on behalf of clients. They are the highest-value B2B subscription users.

Agency accounts are Phase 5. However, the data model should account for multi-brand management from Phase 1 (a single Agency user linked to multiple BrandPage records).

6.2 Representative Persona

Name: Blessing, 36

Occupation: Managing Director, a Lagos-based brand communications agency

Device: MacBook + work desktop

Behaviour pattern: Currently manages 8 client social media accounts across Facebook, Instagram, and LinkedIn using Hootsuite. Has to log into each client's account separately and manually compile reports for monthly client presentations.

What she wants from Straep:

- One login that gives her access to all client brand pages she manages.
- Ability to assign team members to specific client pages.
- Analytics for each client, exportable for client reports.
- White-label reporting (reports that show the client's branding, not Straep's).
- Priority support.

6.3 Primary Actions (Phase 5)

- Create an Agency account.
 - Add client brand pages (create new or link to existing brand pages that the client has given the agency access to).
 - Assign team members to client pages with role-based permissions (Editor, Analyst, Admin).
 - Manage brand page content for each client separately.
 - View analytics across all client pages in a single overview.
 - Generate and export per-client reports.
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7. Account Type Selection UX

The account type selection screen is a critical onboarding step. Users must understand which type applies to them before selecting. Poor design here causes the wrong account type to be chosen, which leads to a confusing experience and higher churn.

7.1 Design Requirements

- Full-screen step — no navigation away until selection is made.
- 5 large cards, one per account type.
- Each card contains:

- Icon (simple and distinct).
- Account type name.
- A one-sentence description.
- 3 bullet points of what this account type can do.
- "Not sure?" helper text with a brief guide.
- Cards are selectable (highlighted on tap/click).
- "Continue" button activates only after a selection is made.
- Users can change account type within 30 days in Settings > Account.

7.2 Card Content

Personal Account

┃ "I want to discover brands, save products, and follow businesses."

- Follow brands and creators.
- Browse deals, content, and opportunities.
- Send inquiries to businesses.

Business / Brand Account

┃ "I have a business and want to build my brand, attract customers, and receive leads."

- Create a customisable brand page.
- List products and services.
- Manage inquiries and customer leads.

Creator / Professional Account

┃ "I am an individual building a personal brand: coach, designer, consultant, creator."

- Build a branded personal page with portfolio.
- List services and receive bookings.
- Grow an audience and publish content.

Developer / Designer Account

┃ "I build and want to sell page templates for Straep brands."

- Upload and sell page templates.
- Track sales and earn revenue.
- Access developer tools and documentation.

Agency Account

┃ "I manage brand pages for multiple clients as an agency or team."

- Manage multiple client brand pages from one login.
- Assign team members and manage permissions.
- View analytics and generate client reports.

7.3 "Not sure?" Guidance (collapsed by default)

Not sure which to pick?

→ If you own or work at a business: choose Business/Brand.

→ If you are a freelancer, coach, or individual professional: choose Creator/Professional.

→ If you are just exploring: choose Personal. You can always upgrade later.

→ If you build websites or design templates: choose Developer.

→ If you manage social media for multiple clients: choose Agency.

8. Permission Matrix

This table defines what each account type can do on the platform.

Action	Personal	Business	Creator	Developer	Agency
Create personal profile	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Follow brands/creators	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Like, comment, save posts	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Send inquiry to a brand	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Create a brand page	—	✓	✓	—	✓ (per client)
Publish posts to feed	—	✓	✓	—	✓
Add products to storefront	—	✓	—	—	✓
Add services	—	✓	✓	—	✓
Access Business Dashboard	—	✓	✓	—	✓
Receive inquiries / leads	—	✓	✓	—	✓
View analytics	—	✓	✓	—	✓
Upload templates	—	—	—	✓	—
Access Developer Dashboard	—	—	—	✓	—
Earn from template sales	—	—	—	✓	—
Manage multiple client pages	—	—	—	—	✓
Assign team members	—	Business plan+	Business plan+	—	✓
Post opportunities	—	Business plan+	—	—	✓
Access Admin panel	—	—	—	—	— (admin role only)

9. Upgrade Pathways Between Account Types

9.1 Personal → Creator/Professional

When a personal user starts adding services or portfolio items, Straep should surface a

prompt:

"It looks like you're building a professional presence. Upgrade to a Creator account to unlock a branded page, service listings, and lead management."

This account type change is available in Settings > Account > Account Type.

9.2 Business → Agency

A Business user who adds team members and requests to manage a second brand page can be prompted to upgrade to the Agency plan.

9.3 Personal → Business

Personal users who follow a business-focused onboarding path (e.g., they mention having a business in their bio) can be prompted mid-session:

"Running a business? Create a free brand page to showcase your products, receive inquiries, and grow your audience."

9.4 Account Type Change Rules

- Account type can be changed within 30 days of registration from Settings > Account.
- After 30 days, account type change requires a support request.
- Changing from Business to Personal downgrades the subscription and hides the brand page (but does not delete it, for a 30-day grace period).
- Changing from Developer to any other type disables the Developer Dashboard but does not delete uploaded templates (they go into "inactive" state).

End of User Types and Personas Document

Next document: 04-Feature-Requirements-Detailed.md